TRAVEL ADVENTURES BY EUNICE

Christmas Markets 2026

Germany and Alsace. Four regions, nineteen markets, every date checked. Stop saying "one year." This is the year.

Heidelberg
and the Rhine Neckar

Alsace
Strasbourg, Colmar and the wine villages

Black Forest
Freiburg, Gengenbach, Baden-Baden

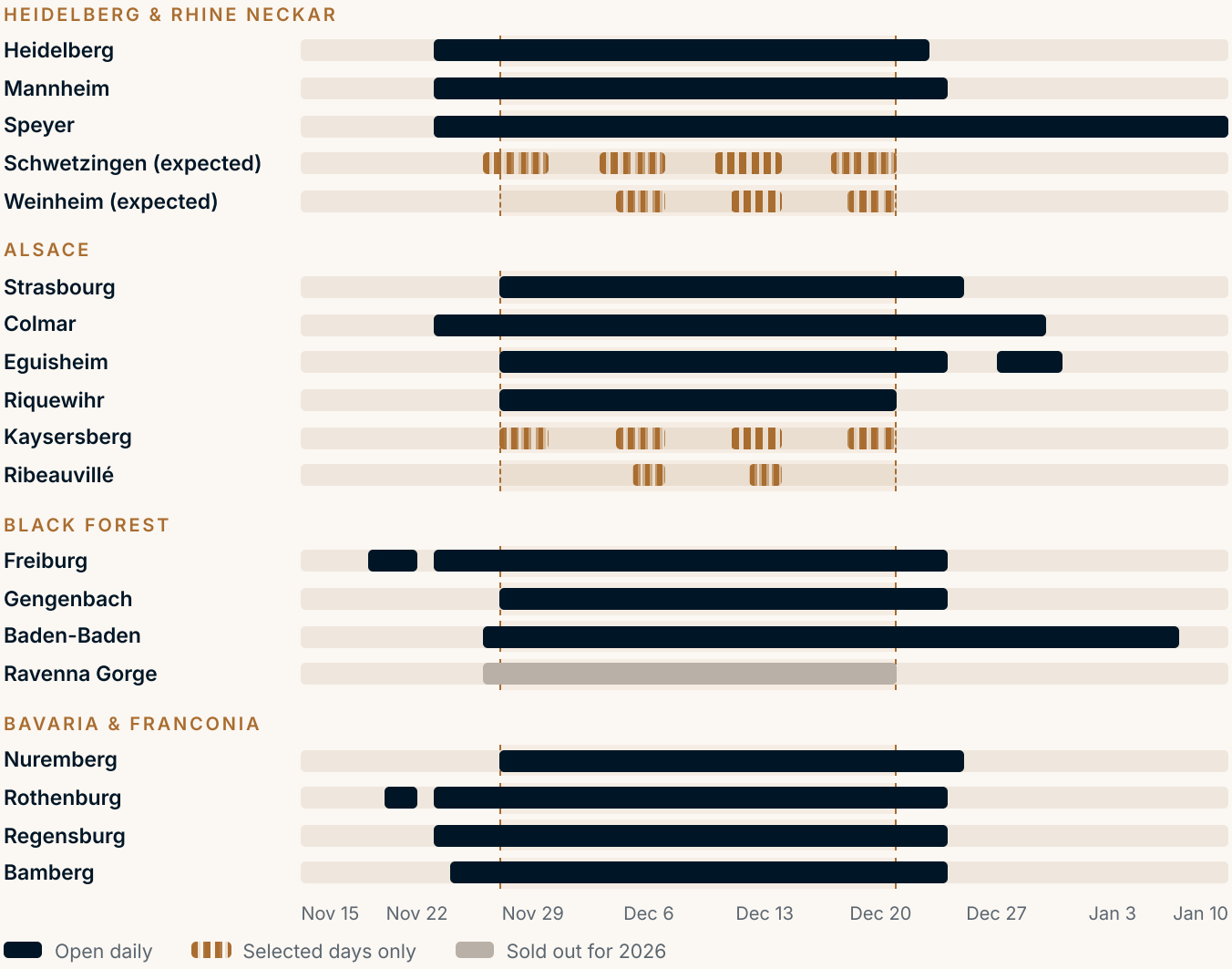
Bavaria
Nuremberg, Rothenburg, Regensburg, Bamberg

Dates checked November 7, 2026. Confirm on the official market page before you book.

START HERE

The whole season on one page

Every market in this guide, on one timeline. The shaded window, **November 27 to December 20**, is when nearly all of them are open at once. Land inside it and you can't get the dates wrong.



Weekend-only markets. Kaysersberg, Ribeauvillé, Schwetzingen and Weinheim open on set days only. Build your trip around them first, then fill the weekdays.

The one weekend that hits everything in Alsace: December 5 to 6, or December 12 to 13. That's when Ribeauvillé's medieval market runs.

REGION ONE

Heidelberg and the Rhine Neckar

One hotel, five markets. Stay in Heidelberg and take the S-Bahn out and back. No packing up every morning.

MARKET	2026 DATES	GOOD TO KNOW
Heidelberg	**Nov 23 to Dec 22** Daily, 11 am to 9 pm	Your base. Spread across the old town squares, so walk it end to end at dusk.
Mannheim	**Nov 23 to Dec 23** Daily, 11 am to 9 pm	Two markets in one trip: the big one at the Wasserturm and the fairy-tale forest on Paradeplatz. A separate craft market runs on the Kapuzinerplanken.
Speyer	**Nov 23 to Jan 9, 2027** Reduced opening Dec 24 to 26	The latest finish in the region. Ice rink by the Altpörtel gate, cathedral at the other end of the street.
Schwetzingen WEEKENDS	**Advent weekends, Thu to Sun** 2026 days not yet announced	Set in front of the palace. Last year it opened Thursday and Friday evenings, and from noon at weekends. Check before you go.
Weinheim WEEKENDS	**Expected Dec 4 to 6, 11 to 13, 18 to 20** Fri 4 pm, Sat and Sun 1 pm, to 9 pm	Small and local on the Marktplatz. Pair it with a Heidelberg weekend.

Put a date on it

Go between **December 4 and 6**. All five markets should be open, including both weekend ones (their 2026 days are still to be confirmed). Three nights in Heidelberg covers it.

REGION TWO

Alsace

Half-timbered villages, mulled white wine and the oldest Christmas market in France. Base yourself in Colmar and let the Christmas shuttles do the driving.

MARKET	2026 DATES	GOOD TO KNOW
Strasbourg	**Nov 27 to Dec 24** Around 11 am to 9 pm	The big one. Closes at 6 pm on Dec 24 and does not reopen after Christmas. Use the park-and-ride tram if you drive.
Colmar	**Nov 23 to Dec 29** Mon to Thu 11 am to 7 pm, Fri to Sun 10 am to 8 pm	Open on Christmas Day. The gourmet market and the Ferris wheel stay until Jan 3, 2027.
Eguisheim	**Nov 27 to Dec 30** Closed Dec 24 to 26	Circular lanes, very walkable. Weekdays until Dec 10 it opens at noon.
Riquewihr	**Nov 27 to Dec 20** Daily from 10 am	Closes early evening (6:30 pm weekdays, 7 pm weekends). Go in the afternoon and stay for the lights.
Kaysersberg FRI TO SUN	**Nov 27 to 29, Dec 4 to 6, 11 to 13, 18 to 20** 10 am to 8 pm	Closed Monday to Thursday. Plan your Colmar stay around one of these weekends.
Ribeauvillé 2 WEEKENDS	**Dec 5 and 6, Dec 12 and 13** Sat 10 am to 7 pm, Sun to 6 pm	The medieval market. Four days only, so this is the one to plan around.

The shuttle that makes this easy

Christmas shuttles leave Colmar station from **Nov 27 to Dec 20** for Kaysersberg, Riquewihr, Ribeauvillé and Eguisheim. Tickets are sold online only, from **November 12 at noon**. Under-12s ride free but still need a reserved ticket. Strasbourg to Colmar is a direct regional train, about 30 to 40 minutes.

REGION THREE

The Black Forest

A market under a railway viaduct, a town hall that turns into an Advent calendar, and a spa town that keeps going into January.

MARKET	2026 DATES	GOOD TO KNOW
Freiburg	**Nov 19 to Dec 23** Closed Sun Nov 22	The earliest opener in this guide. Mon to Sat 10 am to 8:30 pm, Sundays 11:30 am to 7:30 pm.
Gengenbach	**Nov 27 to Dec 23** Daily	The town hall's 24 windows become a giant Advent calendar. One opens every evening at 6 pm from Nov 30 to Dec 23. Be in the square for it.
Baden-Baden	**Nov 26 to Jan 6, 2027** Daily, 11 am to 9 pm	Runs into January. Closes at 3 pm on Dec 24 and Dec 31.
Ravenna Gorge SOLD OUT	**Nov 26 to Dec 20** Thu to Sun only	Timed tickets, sold online only, and 2026 is already gone. Official resale is the only way in now. Dec 10 is reserved for local residents. Put it on next year's list and book the day sales open.

Put a date on it

Freiburg and Gengenbach together, any evening from **November 30**, so you catch a calendar window opening. Add Baden-Baden if you want a spa afternoon between markets.

REGION FOUR

Bavaria and Franconia

Germany's best-known Christmas market, a walled medieval town, and two UNESCO old towns. This is the classic route.

MARKET	2026 DATES	GOOD TO KNOW
Nuremberg	**Nov 27 to Dec 24** Daily, 10 am to 9 pm	The Christkindlesmarkt. Opening night, Nov 27, starts at 5:30 pm. Closes at 2 pm on Dec 24.
Rothenburg ob der Tauber	**Nov 20 to Dec 23** Closed Sun Nov 22	The Reiterlesmarkt inside the town walls. Sun to Thu 11 am to 7 pm, Fri and Sat to 8 pm.
Regensburg	**Nov 23 to Dec 23** Neupfarrplatz, daily	The main market. The romantic market at Thurn und Taxis Palace opens earlier, Nov 20, and charges entry.
Bamberg	**Nov 24 to Dec 23** Maxplatz, daily	Mon to Thu 9:30 am to 8 pm, Fri and Sat to 9 pm, Sun 11 am to 8 pm.

Put a date on it

Start in Nuremberg on **November 27** for opening night, then give Bamberg, Rothenburg and Regensburg a day each. Four towns, all open, before the December crowds peak.

PICK ONE

Four trips. Choose yours.

You don't need all nineteen. You need one route and a date on the calendar.

01

The Alsace week

- Two nights in Strasbourg, three in Colmar
- Shuttles to Riquewihr, Eguisheim and Kaysersberg
- Time it for Dec 5 to 6 or Dec 12 to 13 to add Ribeauvillé

02

Heidelberg, no packing

- One hotel in Heidelberg
- Day trips to Mannheim and Speyer by S-Bahn
- Go Dec 4 to 6 to catch Schwetzingen and Weinheim too

03

Two countries, one border

- Strasbourg on the French side
- Baden-Baden, Gengenbach and Freiburg on the German side
- Any week from Nov 30, when the Gengenbach windows start opening

04

The Franconia classic

- Nuremberg opening night, Nov 27
- Then Bamberg, Rothenburg and Regensburg
- Late November beats mid-December for crowds

Three things to book now, not later

1. Your hotel. December weekends book up fast in the market towns. **2.** Colmar's Christmas shuttles, on sale November 12 at noon. **3.** Any guided market tour you want. Popular dates fill up.

> Most German markets serve mulled wine in a deposit mug. Return it for your deposit back, or keep it as the cheapest souvenir you'll bring home.

YOUR TURN

Done waiting?

Every year there's a reason to push it to next year. The dates are on these pages. The mugs are waiting. All that's missing is you.

Pick one. Put a date on it. Go.

Market tours and day trips for all four regions, in one place.

Some links on this page are affiliate links. I may earn a small commission at no extra cost to you.

See the Christmas market deals

adventureseunice.com/christmas-markets

Follow the trip: **@adventureseunice** on Instagram and Pinterest, **@traveladventuresbyeunice** on YouTube.

About these dates. Every date was checked on November 7, 2026 against the market organisers, tourist offices and local press. Markets sometimes change hours, close for weather or add days. Confirm on the official market page before you book anything non-refundable. Where a 2026 date was not yet announced, this guide says so.

Travel Adventures by Eunice
Rosado Management Solutions Inc.
30 N Gould St, Suite R, Sheridan, WY 82801, USA

Some links are affiliate links. I may earn a small commission at no extra cost to you. Thank you for supporting Travel Adventures by Eunice.